Intrusion Report #2

Intrusion Report
Time: 18:15
IP: 6.87.159.0/24 maded a lot of arp request
Only observation for now, no changes

Time: 18:23
IP: 12.110.206.0/24 has connectoed to ssh
Only observation

At 15:30, both the Admin HTTP interface and the Admin login services went down. The issue was identified and resolved by reactivating the associated network port, restoring full access to the administrative interface and login functionality in 13:45. 23:45 Put a flag in root

```
Name              : sam
SamAccountName    : sam
Enabled           : True
whenCreated       : 2/21/2026 8:29:52 AM
DistinguishedName : CN=sam,CN=Users,DC=team29,DC=isucdc,DC=com
```

Event Viewer

File Action View Help

Event Viewer (Local)
- Custom Views
- Windows Logs
  - Application
  - Security
  - Setup
  - System
  - Forwarded Events
- Applications and Services Lo
  - Active Directory Web Ser
  - DFS Replication
  - Directory Service
  - DNS Server
  - Hardware Events
  - Internet Explorer
  - Key Management Service
  - Microsoft
  - Windows PowerShell
- Subscriptions

Application Number of events: 11,075

| Keywords | Date and Time | Source | Event ID | Task Category |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:45:34 AM | SceCli | 1202 | None |
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:40:31 AM | SceCli | 1202 | None |
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:35:27 AM | SceCli | 1202 | None |
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:30:23 AM | SceCli | 1202 | None |
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:28:16 AM | Security-SPP | 903 | None |
| Classic | 2/21/2026 8:28:16 AM | Security-SPP | 16384 | None |

Event 1202, SceCli

General Details

Security policies were propagated with warning. 0x534 : No mapping between account names and security IDs was done.

Advanced help for this problem is available on http://support.microsoft.com. Query for "troubleshooting 1202 events".

Error 0x534 occurs when a user account in one or more Group Policy objects (GPOs) could not be resolved to a SID. This error is possibly caused by a mistyped or deleted user account referenced in either the User Rights or Restricted Groups branch of a GPO. To resolve this event, contact an administrator in the domain to perform the following actions:

1. Identify accounts that could not be resolved to a SID:

From the command prompt, type: FIND /I "Cannot find" %SYSTEMROOT%\Security\Logs\winlogon.log

The string following "Cannot find" in the FIND output identifies the problem account names.

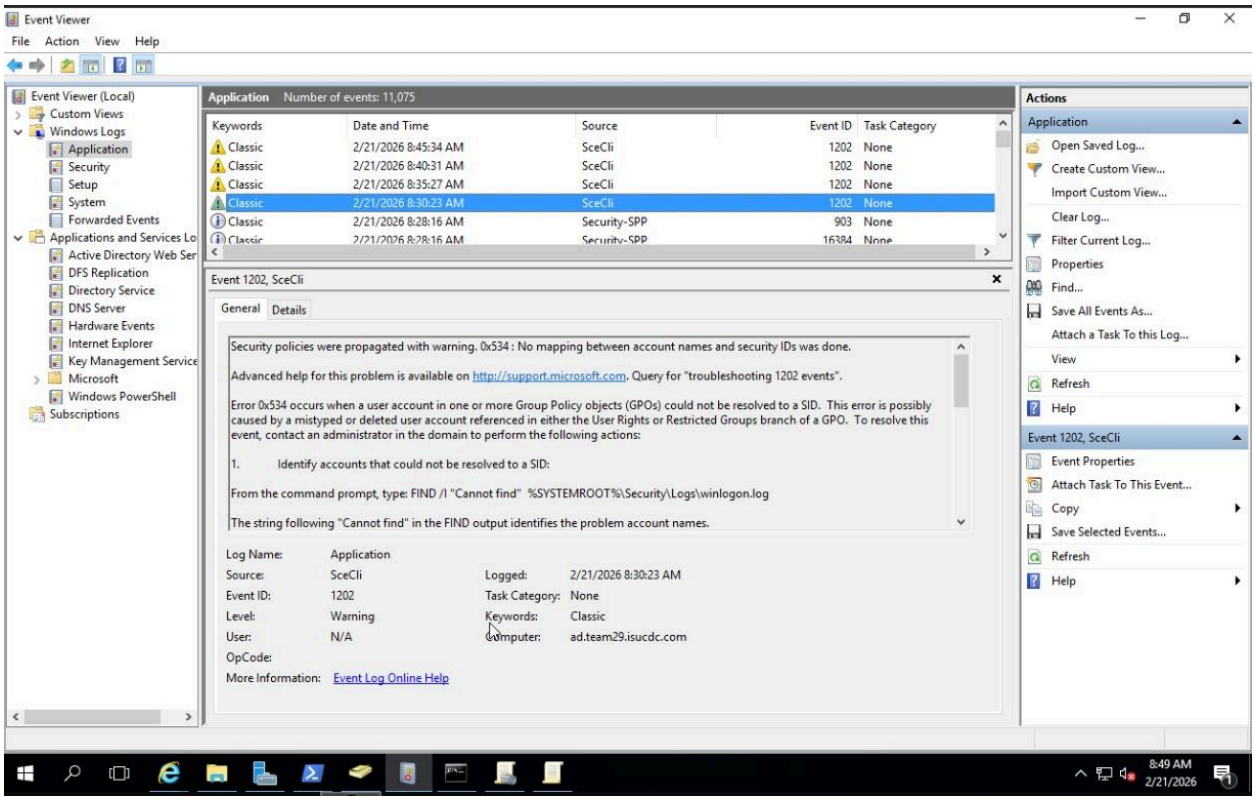
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Log Name: | Application | | |
| Source: | SceCli | Logged: | 2/21/2026 8:45:34 AM |
| Event ID: | 1202 | Task Category: | None |
| Level: | Warning | Keywords: | Classic |
| User: | N/A | Computer: | ad.team29.isucdc.com |
| OpCode: | | | |
| More Information: | Event Log Online Help | | |

Actions

Application
- Open Saved Log...
- Create Custom View...
- Import Custom View...
- Clear Log...
- Filter Current Log...
- Properties
- Find...
- Save All Events As...
- Attach a Task To this Log...
- View
- Refresh
- Help

Event 1202, SceCli
- Event Properties
- Attach Task To This Event...
- Copy
- Save Selected Events...
- Refresh
- Help

8:48 AM




On February 21, 2026, at approximately 08:29 AM, a new Active Directory domain account named “sam” was created within the team29.isucdc.com domain. PowerShell output confirmed the account was enabled at creation and placed in the default CN=Users container with the distinguished name CN=sam,CN=Users,DC=team29,DC=isucdc,DC=com. The creation timestamp of 08:29:52 AM is significant because it was not aligned with any scheduled administrative account provisioning activity performed by our team. This raised immediate concern regarding potential unauthorized access or persistence within the domain environment.

Shortly after the account creation, multiple warnings were recorded in the Application log of the Domain Controller (ad.team29.isucdc.com). Specifically, Event ID 1202 from source SceCli was logged between approximately 08:30 AM and 08:45 AM. The error message stated that security policies were propagated with warning code 0x534, indicating that no mapping between account names and security IDs (SIDs) was completed. Error 0x534 occurs when a user account referenced in a Group Policy Object cannot be resolved to a valid SID. This condition typically results from a deleted account still referenced in policy, a malformed account reference, or unauthorized modifications to user rights assignments or restricted groups within a GPO.

The timing correlation between the creation of the “sam” account and the SID resolution errors suggests a potentially related sequence of events. One plausible scenario is that the newly created account was referenced within a GPO, added to a security group, or involved in a user rights assignment that caused propagation inconsistencies. In intrusion scenarios, attackers frequently create domain accounts to establish persistence or escalate privileges. They may

attempt to assign those accounts administrative rights, add them to privileged groups such as Domain Admins, or manipulate policy settings to maintain access. The presence of GPO-related errors immediately after the account creation supports the hypothesis that the account may have been involved in policy modification activity.

An impact assessment was conducted to determine whether the account had been granted elevated privileges or used for lateral movement. The account's group membership was reviewed using Active Directory queries to confirm whether it belonged to Domain Admins, Enterprise Admins, or other privileged groups. At the time of investigation, no immediate evidence of privilege escalation was identified; however, the fact that the event occurred on the Domain Controller elevates the severity of the incident. Unauthorized domain-level accounts represent a moderate to high risk because they can be leveraged for credential harvesting, unauthorized Remote Desktop access, and domain-wide compromise if not promptly addressed.

Mitigation actions were taken immediately upon identification of the suspicious activity. The account's legitimacy was verified against the team's authorized user baseline. Because the account was not approved, it was removed from Active Directory to eliminate potential persistence. Group Policy was refreshed using gpupdate /force to ensure that any invalid references were cleared and to confirm that Event ID 1202 warnings ceased. Additionally, Group Policy Objects were reviewed to identify any orphaned SIDs or misconfigured user rights assignments that could have caused the propagation errors. Privileged group memberships were audited to confirm that no unauthorized users had been added. Enhanced auditing was also enabled for account management and directory service changes to improve visibility into future domain modifications.

Evidence supporting this investigation includes PowerShell output confirming the creation time and enabled status of the "sam" account, Application log entries showing Event ID 1202 warnings from SceCli, and timestamp correlation between account creation and GPO errors. Screenshots of the logs and command output were preserved to document the incident timeline and remediation steps.

In conclusion, the environment experienced a suspicious domain account creation event followed by Group Policy SID resolution warnings. While no confirmed privilege escalation was identified during the investigation, the nature of the activity and its occurrence on the Domain Controller indicate a potential unauthorized administrative action or intrusion attempt. Prompt remediation actions were implemented to remove the account, correct policy inconsistencies, and enhance monitoring. The domain has been stabilized, and continuous log monitoring is in place to detect any future anomalous account activity or GPO manipulation.